



Close

All good things have a tendency to come to an end. The effervescent and ever-changing nature of technology ensures that the proverbial [ALT] + [F4] plug is pulled from time to time. Is it always a step towards evolution? Read on to find out.

Ashes to ashes, dust to dust

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As habits change so do the technologies that enabled those very habits. Here we look at some of the technologies or cultures that are coming to a close.

The old Web

The web has come a long way since Sir Tim Berners-Lee sent a proposal in 1989 for the creation of a common database to be shared among physicists around the world. But the web was not the same as we see it currently. It has been as simplistic and relied on small hypertext pages.

It consisted of 45 million global users and was all about read-only content with static HTML being used by default. Seems a far cry from today's Web, eh?

Music hoarding

The MP3 player has long since been dead – we wrote its obituary within these pages a couple of years ago – and apart from a few dedicated iPod fans, it isn't resurrecting as a persistent Zombie any time soon. And with this passing of an age in music consumption, our age-old habit of hoarding music has gone forever, too. Why would anyone hoard music anymore when you can play it off the cloud conveniently? Websites like Spotify and Groovespark are evolving our music listening habits on the go, and sparing our hard drives from storing and saving our priceless music collection.

SMS

Everyone remembers the time when they could quickly send 140 letters at once from their mobile phones in the form of SMS.

The technology was simple, SMS services were extremely profitable and phone carriers kept cashing in on it until the advent of Smartphones. The arrival of IM apps didn't help the cause of SMS as people were able to communicate by using cheap data schemes. Apps like Whatsapp piled more



misery on SMS by being available on all major mobile platforms like Android, iOS, Symbian and Windows Phone OS. With that said, SMS has seen its peak and there is not much time left now for it to become completely obsolete in the mobile world.